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Post-big game activities may incur disciplinary action

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(*#_Company_Name_#*) BERKELEY, Calif. -- While University of California-Berkeley students celebrated in the aftermath of Cal's Big Game victory, students caught climbing the goalposts after Saturday's game may face charges from the university, officials said Monday.

Students, including two ASUC senators, were seen swinging from the goalposts after the Big Game, university officials said.

"I was very disappointed in the behavior of our students," said Dean of Students Karen Kenney. "We're very fortunate that no one was hurt."

Kenney added it is too early to determine which conduct rules were violated but acknowledged that the situation is very serious.

Even more disappointing, Kenney said, is that some of the students involved hold positions in the ASUC.

"At least two, if not more student leaders were involved in activities involving the goalposts," she said.

One of the students seen in photographs climbing the poles was Student Action Senator Tasvir Patel.

Patel said he did not expect to receive as much attention as he did.

"It was all about school spirit," Patel said. "I didn't realize that I was that high (on the goal post) or it was that long of a time."

But Kenney said the damaged property was disturbing. The uprooting of the goalposts endangered students present at the game, she added.

Patel said he is worried he may lose his position as a senator but said his actions on Big Game day do not hinder his ability to perform his official duties.

"What I do on the senate floor doesn't reflect my personal life," he said. "I'm a student first, I'm a senator second."

But others in the ASUC Senate disagreed, adding that students involved should be punished.

"If there were students directly involved in the destruction of goalposts, they should be culpable (for) their actions," said Berkeley College Republicans Senator Paul LaFata. "If I were the university, I would pursue it."

ASUC President Jesse Gabriel said a week before the Big Game UC police warned students not to be disruptive on the field. Police told students they would use high-powered surveillance cameras inside the stadium to monitor student activity.

But Gabriel added it is tradition for students to participate in post-game celebration on the field.

"Anyone that expects students not to rush the field after the Big Game is ridiculous," he said.

The amount of damages to the university on Big Game day have not yet been determined, said Hatcher Parnell,

assistant events manager.

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